

on in Zoom to begin streaming.

- Enable close captioning in zoom for accessibility.
- Once the call starts, do a round of introductions asking the question: "what brought you to this call". This will help you adjust the call to the community's needs and, answer any questions/meet their expectations.
- Keep detailed meeting minutes

After the call

- Add the youtube video to the "office hour calls" playlist
- Post a recap and the video recording on Discord

Community challenge

To encourage contribution to priority issues on an on-going basis (and not just during Hackathons), we will maintain a list of up to 5 priority issues for each product stage and prizes will be given to wider community members who have MRs merged for these issues. These issues will have the label Community challenge and more details such as prizes, assignment of these issues, etc.

Community Newsletter

We run a Community Newsletter to share developer-focused content, alert community members about upcoming events, and keep contributors engaged. The focus of the newsletter is on driving contributions and engagement. It will not be used to generate or nurture leads and allow us to connect with and share our community's contributions.

Supporting the Wider Community Contributors

Unblocking wider community contributions

Following GitLab's mission that Everyone can contribute, the Contributor Success team helps unblock wider community contributors and move contributions forward. Sometimes other teams at GitLab do not have the capacity to support community contributions, but this should not stop the community from contributing.

These 10 GitLab values support efforts to unblock the wider community and push forward:

1. Do it yourself
1. Short toes
1. Collaboration is not consensus
1. Bias for action
1. Disagree, commit, and disagree
1. Escalate to unblock
1. Cleanup over sign-up
1. Minimal valuable change
1. Everything is in draft
1. Make two-way door decisions

Seeking wider community contributions

GitLab team members seeking help can reach out to the wider community for contributions. It is suggested to start with smaller quick win issues that have a clear implementation plan before moving on to bigger project requests.

- Add a quick win label to the issue by following the criteria for quick win issues.
- Share the issue on the GitLab Community Discord in the contribute channel.
- If a community contributor expresses interest, assign them to the issue.
- Follow up with the community contributor to see if they need help.

Criteria for quick win issues

GitLab guides the wider community to search for issues with the quick win label when looking to contribute. These issues are intended to be straightforward for community contributors and quick enough to complete while still learning the contribution process. This follows GitLab's mission to enable everyone to contribute and to support our first-time contributors onboarding with the community. The GitLab Bot helps to maintain this criteria and will remove the quick win label when an issue does not meet the requirements.

- The issue description must include an implementation plan as a second or third level heading with guidance to help contributors get started.
For example Implementation, Implementation, Implementation plan and Implementation guide are all acceptable.
This section can be very brief or offer possible actions to resolve the issue.
- The issue must be assigned a weight between 0-3.
Issue weights should approximate the complexity and effort required.
Do not relate weight to time estimates.
- Consider including a GitLab team member or experienced community contributor as a contact person for contributors to ask questions or get mentorship.

Criteria for quick win::first-time contributor issues

During the onboarding process, new contributors are linked to quick win::first-time contributor issues. These issues are intended to help new contributors learn the process of contributing by using our easiest and most straight forward issues.

quick win::first-time contributor issues follow the same quick win criteria as above, with modified weight requirements. It is also recommended to add a support contact.

- The issue must be assigned a weight between 0-1.
Issue weights should approximate the complexity and effort required.
Do not relate weight to time estimates.
- The issue description must include an implementation plan as a second or third level heading with guidance to help contributors get started.
For example Implementation, Implementation, Implementation plan and Implementation guide are all acceptable.
This section can be very brief or offer possible actions to resolve the issue.
- It's recommended to include at least 1 GitLab team member or experienced community

contributor (e.g., "Support contact: @username") tagged in the Implementation plan section

First-time contributors

Every time a contributor is opening a merge request to a GitLab namespace for the first time, the label "~1st contribution" is automatically applied to the merge request.

Once the merge request is reviewed and merged, the contributor can apply for the myfirstMRmerged gift via a self-nomination form on the nominations for GitLab swag page.

Contributor Success team members can use the outreach email/message template when sending the link for the first-time contributor gift.

Working with the Core Team

More information on the Core Team is available in the Core Team handbook page.

GitLab Duo for Contributors

To support our mission to enable everyone to contribute, we offer complimentary GitLab Duo Enterprise

licenses across the GitLab community forks for all our wider community contributors.

GitLab Duo features Code Suggestions, Chat, Root Cause Analysis

and more AI-powered features to help boost efficiency and effectiveness by reducing the time required

to write and understand code and pipelines.

Community contributors receive GitLab Duo once approved for requesting access to the community forks.

Highlighting high-value contributions with product bonuses

This is an experiment that we run in FY25Q4 (November 2024 - January 2025).

To highlight high-value contribution directions, the contributor success team might set up a dedicated budget that product managers (PM) can give out to contributors in their area in a given timeframe. The overall budget is shared equally across user-facing product stages where PMs can apply labels (community-bonus::100. community-bonus::300. community-bonus::500) to show how much value they give to the specific issue/epic. The bonus is accounted for when the issue is closed or in case of an epic, the contributor success team can give out part of the bonus for specific issues as discussed by the respective PM. PMs are expected to stay within their budgets when selecting issues.

Bonuses can be granted after the contribution too.

A bonus in this context is not a monetary grant. These bonus points can only be used to make purchases in the contributor store.

For contributors who don't own a credit card

For contributors who don't own a credit card and need to be manually verified, a GitLab team

member can open an internal request using the Other -> Other License and Renewals related issue template. GitLab Support will follow the Manual credit card validation process described in the handbook to complete the request.

For contributors who run out of compute minutes or other CI/CD resources

Wider community members may run out of monthly compute minutes, or run into other GitLab CI/CD limits if they are working from a personal fork.

The solution is to work from the GitLab community forks.

Contacting contributors

To be respectful to the contributor's privacy, we will only use contact data that is publicly available to reach out to them.

Here are some ways to reach out to contributors to e.g. distribute Hackathon prizes or MVP swag:

- You can mention them in an issue using their GitLab user name.
- In private through our communication platform (Discord, Slack, etc.).
- A user might have e-mail or Twitter info on their GitLab profile. Sometimes users have the same username in other platforms (e.g. GitHub), and might have more information on their profiles there.
- Their e-mail address is stored in their git commits, unless they choose to use a private commit e-mail.

If you need assistance finding a contributor's email address please see [Finding Community Member Contact Information](#)

Once you've found out the best way to contact them, you can choose to use a mention, e-mail or Twitter for instance.

Contributor blog post series

Goal is to publish a regular blog post featuring contributors from the community. The format will be a casual Q&A with a community member and will be posted on the GitLab blog page.

When developing a blog post, follow the [blog guidelines](#).

Contributor outreach campaigns

Outreach campaigns help us reconnect with past contributors to GitLab who have stopped or users who have expressed interest in contributing but have not started.

When reaching out, we plant trees in the GitLab forest in their name to recognize their past and/or potential future contributions.

Outreach goals

The Contributor Success team experimented with different criteria and messages to create a

repeatable

outreach campaign with three goals:

1. Maximize community members opening new merge requests
1. Minimize time commitment from Contributor Success to run the campaign
1. Prevent outreach campaigns from being a nuisance or appearing like marketing spam

Candidate criteria for return contributors

- 0 opened merge requests in the last 3 months
- Must have merged 2 or more merge requests in the last 12 months
- Has not previously been contacted in an outreach campaign

Candidate criteria for new contributors

- Requested and received access to the community forks at least 1 month ago
- No merged merge requests in their history
- Has not previously been contacted in an outreach campaign

Tracking Results

Outreach campaign results are tracked in the Outreach results spreadsheet and reported in the Report on all outreach campaigns issue.

Results for return contributor campaigns

Outreach campaign	Criteria	Total outreach users	Returned users	User return rate
Merged MR	Opened MR	Closed MR		
December 2023	6 months idle	49	7	14.29%
11	0	2		
January 2024	3 months idle	124	12	9.68%
15	2	2		
April 2024	3 months idle	40	5	12.50%
12	1	1		

Results for new contributor campaigns

Outreach campaign	Criteria	Total outreach users	Returned users	User return rate
Merged MR	Opened MR	Closed MR		
April 2024	0 contributions	274	6	2.19%
4	2	1		

Observations on results

- To date, the return contributor campaigns has been a success with an average user return rate of 11%, 24 returned contributors, and 38 merged merge requests.

- The April experiment with a new contributor campaign was less successful with a 2% contribution rate.
- This campaign did not have a time restriction on how long ago users requested community forks access and likely many users had lost interest in getting started.
- It is expected that return contributors would be more successful than new contributors in opening a merge request.
- In addition to opened and merged merge request results, we observed user engagement in the issues, onboarding task completion, and appreciation of the tree planting.
- Many contributors will not have the availability to make a merge request within 1 month of the outreach to appear in these results. The campaign might be a positive reminder of the opportunity to contribute at a later time.

Outreach campaign scheduling

Outreach campaigns are targeted to run every 3 months but should coincide with an announcement that might entice contributors.

For example, announcing an upcoming hackathon or a new contributing feature like GDK-in-a-box.

Outreach campaign workflow

Review candidate pool

The Contributor Success team reviews the candidate pool to remove:

- Any known GitLab team members with either a GitLab account or a personal account
- Longstanding contributors who have lapsed but should be contacted separately outside of the campaign (e.g. Core members, former MVPs, GitLab Heroes, etc.)
- Any known community members who have had code of conduct violations, expressed they do not want to be contacted, or expressed they do not want to contribute to GitLab

Create issues and plant trees

- Use the temporary branch temp-outreach-path in the reward engine project
- Paste candidate usernames into the recipients variable in the RewardIssuer module
- Run bundle exec bin/rewardengine
- Use a personal access token so the outreach message comes from a real team member instead of a bot

Responding and closing outreach issues

- Answer any questions or acknowledge feedback in the outreach issues
- Close outreach issues after 2 month period with a closing message encouraging the contributor to reopen the issue and reach out if they would like support

Potential iterations

- Reduce the manual review step with automation by checking candidates against role criteria or list of candidates to exclude
- Thank users who contribute after the outreach campaign in their respective issues which might

give opportunity for them to share why they came back

Recognition for contributors

Appreciation for highlighted contributions

From time to time, a wider community member will submit a particularly outstanding contribution. Other than thanking them on the MR, we might want to additionally show our appreciation by sending them some GitLab merchandise. Anyone in the GitLab team or in the wider community can follow the process to nominate a contributor.

Top Annual Contributors

In order to recognize regular contributors, the list of top contributors for each calendar year will be published in the Top Annual Contributors page. There will be three categories of top contributors:

- SuperStar: more than 75 MRs merged
- Star: between 11 and 75 MRs merged
- Enthusiast: between 5 and 10 MRs merged

Customized GitLab merchandise will be created for these contributors and will be available on Printfection. For GitLab team members, you can follow the steps below to get the awards to the wider community members.

1. Login to Printfection using the credentials in 1Password.
1. Under Campaigns, go to Giveaways and create a new GIVEAWAY CAMPAIGN (you may need to create a new Kit under the Merchandise tab if you want to include more than one item).
1. Add the item/kit to the campaign.
1. Generate Giveaway links for each contributors.
1. Include the Giveaway link in the individual email to the Top Annual Contributors.

Contributor lifecycle segments

In an effort to understand, support, and empower the GitLab code contributor community, we have come up with the following lifecycle segments.

These lifecycle segments are assigned on an individual user level. For organizational recognition, see Leading Organizations.

Contributor Experience level	MRs merged
Level 0	0 MRs
Level 1	1 - 3 MRs
Level 2	4 - 25 MRs
Level 3	26 - 75 MRs
Level 4	75+ MRs

Contributor Status	MRs merged	Timeframe

Casual contributor	< 10 MRs	Last 6 months
Regular contributor	10+ MRs	Last 6 months
Leading contributor	20+ MRs	last 6 months
Core	Election based	All time

Segmenting our contributor community will allow us to understand better how contributors "move" across this funnel and how we can better support them through their journey.

The goal is to increase code contributors across all segments (except the inactive ones), by identifying ways to support and reward our contributors.

Contributor metrics

Note: this is currently a working list of all locations where we can currently gather contributor metrics. It is not yet the final set of metrics we will be using to monitor the success of the contributor program with.

Tableau dashboards

Internally, GitLab uses Tableau for tracking down the performance of various KPIs. Below you can find a list of community-related dashboards.

Dashboard	Description
Wider Community Dashboard	Metrics associated to contributors (people) and organizations
MRARR Dashboard	Metrics associated to contributing organizations who are also a customer of GitLab

GitLab.com

You can also directly query data from Merge Requests pages for projects (e.g. CE, EE, Omnibus, Shell, etc.) on gitlab.com and apply appropriate filters for milestone, labels, etc. Some of the examples are listed in the metrics table below.

Number of Contributors

In the past we often mentioned 2,000+ contributors in the GitLab community (GitLab team members + wider community) as you can see in this example. However, this only included contributors to CE and EE projects based on the old <https://contributors.gitlab.com> page.

If you include other GitLab projects, the total number of contributors is much larger.

- Total code contributors: includes GitLab team members and wider community contributors (since 2015)
- Wider community code contributors: includes wider community contributors only (since 2015)
- These figures count contributors who have opened at least one merge request, regardless of whether the merge request has been merged, closed or is still open.
- The number of wider community code contributors with a successful contributions (whose Merge Requests have been merged), can be found by looking at the Wider Community Dashboard.

- See our top misused terms page for a refresher on the definition of wider community members.

When people ask about the number of contributors at GitLab, it's best to clarify if they're asking about total code contributors or wider community code contributors. In most cases, people tend to be more interested in the wider community number.

It's also important to mention that there are other ways the community contributes to GitLab other than code, as listed in our Contribute to GitLab guide. Contributions like Translations, Evangelism, support on our Forum, and opened issues are not included in the metrics above.

Monitored projects

We monitor and recognize contributions across a variety of projects on the gitlab-org group, not only the GitLab project.

As a general rule, a project will be set up for monitoring wider community contributions if it uses the gitlab-org group milestones and the Community contribution label.

See the exhaustive list of monitored gitlab-org group projects.

Are you interested in contributing to GitLab? Check out the available contribution opportunities here.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/community-hackathons.md

DRI: Arianna Haradon

About

GitLab Hackathons bring our community together to improve GitLab. These quarterly events support Contributor Success by providing structured opportunities for community engagement and contribution.

For more information and live tracking, please visit the hackathon page.

Workflow

- Owned by the Contributor Success team.
- Typically occurs once per quarter.
- Hackathons run for 7 days (UTC). Any MR opened during the hackathon week must be merged by 31 days after the hackathon week.
 - During the 7 day hackathon period, all community contribution MRs are automatically tagged with the hackathon label and count towards the hackathon.
- Leaderboard here.
- Some hackathons have themes or special bonus prizes like:
 - Smash the most bugs for bonus credits to our Contributor Success store.
 - Product teams create curated issue lists and award community bonuses, ex Knowledge Group Hackathon list.

Collaboration Opportuntites

Contributor Success welcomes new ideas/themes for the hackathon. Please reach out to us on contributor-success on Slack for internal discussion.

Experiments and results

April 2025 Hackathon

Bug bash bonus prize:

- 250 credit bonus to the contributor who merged the most type::bug merge requests
- Credits were in addition to other hackathon prizes
- Bonus was advertized on all external hackathon announcements.
- Bonus was not advertized on contributors.gitlab.com.

Results:

- No material change in the number of participants or bugs resolved.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/community-pairing-sessions.md

Community pairing sessions

What are they?

The community pairing sessions are community-driven sessions, usually 1 hour long, that anyone from the GitLab community (team members and not) can attend. We cover:

- How to contribute to GitLab
- GitLab Development Kit (GDK) set up
- Live coding including but not limited to
 - the GitLab project
 - a satellite/related project
 - Backend
 - Frontend
 - Database
 - Documentation
- How to triage issues
- Brainstorming

These sessions are livestreamed on our Community Coders YouTube channel and are thought to be a friendly and informal environment, where everyone is free to express their thoughts (in accordance to the GitLab Code of Conduct).

When do they happen?

We typically have two weekly pairing sessions.

Day	Local time	UTC Time
-----	-----	-----
Tuesdays	12:15 PM CET/CEST	10:15/11:15
Thursdays	3:00 PM EDT/EST	19:00/20:00

On rare occasions, a scheduled session might be skipped if none of the organizers can attend.

Keep an eye on the contribute channel of the GitLab Discord server for any announcement.

Ad-hoc sessions can be requested by anyone who needs help, or just wants to share some work they're doing, by asking in the contribute channel of the GitLab Discord server. Ping one or more of the organizers if you have no reply in about 1 hour, but keep in mind that most of them are located in the UTC+1/UTC+2 timezone.

Where do they happen?

Community pairing sessions are organized using Zoom and the link to join the session can be found:

- In our Discord server events.
- In the recurring GitLab Meetup event, named GitLab Community pairing.

Preparing for a scheduled session (for organizers)

- A recurring event exists on Meetup.com, so no manual setup is needed.
- A scheduled pipeline creates the Discord event each week using a Ruby script.
- Advertise on social media (optional).

The day of the session:

- Leave a message in the contribute channel of the GitLab Discord server to raise awareness and/or decide what to look at during the session.

During the session:

- Make sure the streaming to YouTube is active.
- Explain what we're going to cover during the session.
- Start having fun!

Organizers

Due to our current workflow to create and attend these sessions, at least one of the organizers must attend in order to be able to livestream to our YouTube channel.

Organizer	GitLab handle	Discord handle
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Lee Tickett	@leetickett-gitlab	@leetickett
Arianna Haradon	@aharadon	@aharadon
Raimund Hook	@stingrayza	@stingrayza
Daniel Murphy	@daniel-murphy	@daniel-murphy
Marco Zille	@zillemarco	@zillemarco

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/contributing-org-tracker.md

Learn how to add and maintain usernames to organizations for recognition and award purposes within GitLab

Where is the tracking sheet?

Contributing Orgs tracker

What is this sheet used for?

- Link user accounts on GitLab.com to customers known to GitLab
- Format this in a form digestible to our BI tools by formatting it into JSON
- List the entry & exit dates of organizations into our Leading Organizations program

Tabs

MRARR Organization

Each customer known to GitLab to have contributed in the past is listed here with their Salesforce ID, a validation if they are already in the sheet and a tabular list of known user accounts that belong to that organization.

MRARR Concise

Once the users are added to the MRARR Organization tab, the MRARR Concise summarizes this information for consumption by our BI tooling.
You should not edit this tab.

In our BI tooling, this tab can be found as legacy.sheetloadgitlabcontributingorganizations in the SAFE Intermediate Dashboards.

Leading Organization

Each organization known to GitLab to have been onboarded in the Leading Organization program is listed here, including the start date and the potential exit date.

It includes individuals that are not known in our Salesforce system, but still qualify for getting the benefits such as the Review Time SLO. The type of this column is a boolean.

In our BI tooling, this tab can be found as workspaceengineering.leadingorganizationentrydates in the SAFE Intermediate Dashboards.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/innovation-pitch-competition.md

Innovation Pitch Competition

Concept & Goals

Executive Summary

This initiative was designed to engage our community, stimulate innovation, and showcase creativity within our field, marking a significant milestone in our commitment to fostering talent and recognizing outstanding contributions.

Participants submitted a 2.5-minute video pitch, promoting their proof of concept, and a proof of concept.

A jury of GitLab team members selected the top pitches.

Fulfillment Partner to run this competition was DevPost

Winners were announced during an Innovation Pitch Competition Finale live stream on YouTube

Some selected contributions can receive follow up investment post events (ref: Deep Dive sessions).

An in-depth background document has been compiled, detailing iterations, context, and foundational materials for potential future use. Additionally, a separate document outlines the responsibilities of the competition's DRI from December to March, featuring a to-do list and numerous links to various support documents.

Participants eligibility criteria

Participants needed to be the legal age of majority in country of residence

Companies/professional organizations were excluded from participation

Specific countries/territories excluded: Belarus, Brazil, Cambodia, China, Crimea, Cuba, Islamic Republic of Iran, Democratic People's Republic of Korea, Myanmar, Quebec, Russia, Syrian Arab Republic, Ukraine and Venezuela.

Timeline

Launch: 2024-01-16, 12 PM (PST)

Entry Deadline: 2024-02-26, 11:45 PM (PST)

Judging: 2024-02-29 - 2024-03-06

Winner Announcement: 2024-03-11, during the GitLab Pitch Show

Rules and Guidelines

For the competition entry, participants had to build an innovative pitch into a proof of concept on GitLab. They had to make a 2.5 minute video demoing the project and include a text description about the problem it solves.

The proof of concept demos had to do at least one of the following: expand the global CI/CD catalog with CI/CD component additions, conduct AI experiments with/on GitLab, contribute to the development of GitLab, create a social impact for the Wider GitLab Community, or enhance the overall quality of GitLab.

Submissions to the competition had to meet the following requirements:

- A demo video of the project which should not be more than 2.5 minutes.

- Video should include footage that shows the Project functioning, and be uploaded and made publicly visible on YouTube (preferred), Vimeo, Facebook Video, or Youku.

- A working proof of concept for the project in a publicly visible repository on GitLab.com

- Provide a URL to the open-source code repository, licensed under the MIT license.

- A text description explaining the features and functionality of the project as they relate to the judging criteria.

The official rules are published on DevPost.

Participant engagement

Participants were offered resources to get started, to contribute to GitLab and to contact GitLab and get support.

Participants were kept up to date mainly via an Updates channel on DevPost. Each time an update was published, all participants were sent an email containing the information of the update.

Participants could contact the GitLab team via a Discussions channel on DevPost. The GitLab team also made use of this channel to craft FAQ's.

The GitLab team organized 4 AMA's (video sessions) which ran on Discord.

- AMA 1: General info on the Innovation Pitch Competition

- AMA 2: How to Give a Great Pitch

- AMA 3: Public Speaking 101

- AMA 4: The Importance of Feedback and Iteration

Competition marketing

GitLab made use of a marketing package offered by DevPost.

GitLab social media strategy

GitLab description marketing campaign

Judging Criteria and Process

The entries were evaluated on 6 judging criteria:

- Does it solve a real problem for GitLab users?

- Innovativeness

- Overall Quality

- Scalability

- Total Addressable Market

- Feasibility

Extra informative criterion given to the jury members: Evaluate the contributor's ability to advance, execute, and potentially scale the project. It's crucial they possess the coding skills needed to further develop the proof of concept (POC) for additional funding.

Judges were given 5 working days (2024-02-29 - 2024-03-06) to evaluate the entries via a spreadsheet.

The judging process occurred in two phases.

In the first wave, nine judges with diverse backgrounds assessed the submissions. Their evaluations determined the initial selection, resulting in an initial ranking.

Following this initial wave, entries underwent further evaluation. The Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) and the VP of Developer Relations conducted an async voting session with the

Director of Contributor Success to score these submissions.

The final scores were calculated by aggregating the assessments from all jury members.

Judges (exclusively GitLab team members)

Ashley Kramer, CMO

Emilio Salvador, VP, Developer Relations

Dov Herschkovitch, Senior Product Manager, Pipeline Authoring - Verify

Lee Tickett, Staff Fullstack Engineer

Jocelyn Eillis, Product Manager

Sheela Viswanathan, Senior Manager, Sales Systems

Christian Couder, Staff Backend Engineer GitLab: Git

Christina Lohr, Senior Product Manager, Data Stores Tenant Scale

Dave Steer, VP, Brand & Product Marketing

Lis Vinueza, Analytics Engineer

Results and Winners

Participation Overview

916 individual registrations to the competition.

69 validated projects (out of 110 submissions).

Main participants specialties:

1. Full Stack Developer (46.1%)
2. Data Scientist (13.3%)
3. Front-end and Back-end developers (both 9%)

Main participants submissions topics:

4. Social Impact (34.8%)
5. AI (26.1%)
6. CI/CD catalog (24.6%)

Winner Announcement

Winners were announced during an Innovation Pitch Competition Finale live stream on YouTube.

The winners were also announced on the DevPost Project Gallery.

What made them stand out?

The top entries boast significant impact potential - be it through innovation, utility, or market viability, or perhaps a dynamic blend of these elements.

Prizes

Prize money: \$30,000 USD

Public Vote Prizes: 3 Tier-3 GitLab swag packages for the first 3

GitLab had the option to provide winning projects with additional support or benefits beyond the prize money at its discretion. Winning projects were considered for additional support of up to \$100,000 USD in value. Should any extra support be given, it would be managed under a separate agreement, independent of the competition's official rules.

Feedback and Observations

Participant Feedback

Participants had the opportunity to communicate with the team through a public Discussions board on the DevPost website. Here, participants submitted their questions, and the team provided responses. Additionally, questions asked during the four AMA (Ask Me Anything) sessions were summarized by a team member and then posted on the discussion board. Upon reviewing all the questions, it was observed that there was no specific theme, common thread, or frequently asked questions that emerged.

We received some negative feedback from participants concerning the strict application of our rules for submissions such as the due date, hosting location of the video & repository, length of the movie and more.

Judges' Insights

Evaluating a submission and scoring it was less obvious for a few key reasons:

A lack of specific product (hashtag) expertise.

No scheduled team collaboration during the judging period.

The complexity of measuring the 'impact' criterion. Some entries align perfectly with our current goals, while others could be influential if we shift our focus. How to fairly assess these varying potentials?

Organizational Learnings

The competition's leading DRI should be a versatile talent, adept in project management and enriched with marketing, legal, and digital communication expertise. This individual must be an active listener, strategist, and suggestion-generator, capable of both crafting and executing operational plans. For this inaugural event, the role was particularly demanding, requiring tailored documentation for different departments each with its unique viewpoint. This entailed creating both succinct overviews and detailed reports, distributed through diverse channels including email, Google Docs, GitLab, and Slack.

The competition's launch was delayed, primarily due to unforeseen legal complexities. Given it was the event's first edition, these hurdles weren't attributable to any oversight. The legal framework's completion exceeded expectations in time, as aspects such as prize distribution, intellectual property rights, participant eligibility, licensing, and the overall procedural wording presented new challenges for GitLab.

Despite their high quality, the 4 AMA video sessions achieved limited success, marking the effort-to-value ratio as suboptimal.

Securing feedback and movie clips from jury members proved challenging. In the future, informing them to schedule more time for these additional tasks well in advance is advisable.

The final week of the competition, marked by jury scoring, deciding on winners, and orchestrating the GitLab Pitch Show, turned into an exceptionally intense period. The unique pressures of this first-time event, compounded by unforeseen circumstances, heightened the challenge. Amid this whirlwind and the GitLab Team's preparations for a team offsite, the stress reached a peak, leading to a minor hiccup in announcing the winners - a small misstep in an otherwise nail-biting week.

At the time of writing the results of the Deep Dives are unknown.

Feedback of fulfillment partner DevPost

Overall very helpful.

The marketing package significantly boosted visibility within the DevPost community. Announcing through DevPost mailings led to a marked increase in traffic to the competition's website.

During the competition, a few minor miscommunications and unforeseen adjustments arose. Notably, a significant confusion occurred with the public vote announcement publishing all legal and non-spam submissions, a number far exceeding those actually eligible. Clarifying the difference between "accepted" and "validated" submissions is essential, as it shapes the public voting process and the distribution of public prizes.

Impact Assessment

Achievement of Objectives: Evaluate whether the competition met its intended goals

Community engagement and innovation showcase initiative: This program was meticulously crafted to actively involve our community, ignite innovation, and spotlight creativity within our industry. It represents a significant milestone in our ongoing commitment to nurturing talent and acknowledging exceptional contributions.

Initial intent and adaptation: Originally, we aimed to establish Key Performance Indicators (KPIs). However, given that this was the inaugural edition, we lacked a baseline for comparison. Consequently, we made the deliberate decision not to set KPIs for this iteration.

Strategic learning and future preparedness: This edition was intentionally designed to maximize our learning experience, laying the groundwork for future editions. Alongside documenting internal processes, we meticulously analyzed topics of interest, participant profiles, and communication channels.

Evidence of success: Considering the impressive participation of 916 individuals, the influx of 482 new users who had never engaged with GitLab before, and the validation of 69 submissions, we confidently declare this edition a resounding success. Additionally, the quality of eligible submissions, heightened activity across various channels, and a remarkable 50% increase in contributions to the CI/CD catalog further reinforce this achievement. Details are available via a separate document

Future Recommendations

Improvements

Suggestions for improving future iterations of the competition based on feedback and observations.

Prepare a FAQ for participants based on the questions asked during this edition.

Add "custom submission questions" to the initial participants' entry form. Such questions make the eligibility process much faster later on in the competition.

Expand the competition's reach by partnering with educational institutions, social impact groups, and other organizations, offering them customized media packages for promotion or creating specific subcategories to engage them.

Enhance GitLab team involvement by framing the competition as a collective endeavor, especially for competitions with a social impact theme, to boost team engagement.

The competition's social media presence was limited, with GitLab's marketing efforts not translating into significant traffic spikes. A review on how to enhance this aspect is needed.

Increase the marketing budget allocated for promotions through DevPost.

Despite our best efforts to streamline scoring for the judges with clear, timely instructions, we recognize room for improvement based on insights gained from this first experience. Main recommendation is organizing a short post-judging, pre-announcement meeting to evaluate the scores. During such a meeting jury members are given the opportunity to adjust their scores with 1 point (positive or negative). This meeting should be scheduled well in advance. It is also essential to share a centralized and reliable record of competition winners with the relevant team members.

Update for Jury Guidelines: Jurors are required to score a set number of submissions, with additional evaluations being optional.

Originally, our jury utilized a single, comprehensive spreadsheet with individual tabs for each member—a system that suited us well. Unexpectedly, DevPost shifted to separate spreadsheets for each judge. Despite their good intentions, this change posed an inconvenience from our standpoint.

Potential for Recurrence

Discuss whether the competition should become a recurring event and, if so, any proposed changes to its format or scope.

This inaugural edition set the groundwork for future iterations, hence the detailed documentation.

For subsequent editions with similar objectives, a 2 to 3-month lead time from inception to public announcement is anticipated, leveraging existing materials and insights.

Narrow down on exactly what GitLab wants to achieve with a future competition :

- Development of new functionality

- More CI/CD components

- More GitLab Duo (AI) projects

- A focus on Social Impact projects

- Activate certain regions more

- Investing in and developing new projects/ventures

Address the legal aspects of reward structures. Design participant incentives that minimize legal complexities, thus widening the competition's accessibility globally. Investigate non-monetary incentives such as presenting to management, donating developer time for projects, mentoring opportunities, and enhancing visibility. Some incentives might also be offered as supplementary to the main competition.

Tackle intellectual property (IP) legalities proactively, but only once the competition's aims and framework are established.

Evaluate entrusting DevPost with complete project management responsibilities rather than limiting their role to mid-level management tasks. Full project management will give GitLab a dedicated project manager who runs the project planning, offers best practices along the way, helps engage participants, provides additional assistance by participating in office hours and workshops, keeps things highly organized, and includes structured weekly call times.

Format suggestions for future events

These format ideas emerged during the Innovation Pitch Competition. Although these formats were initially developed as "spinoffs," they have garnered positive feedback from several team members. These ideas are supported by the team to consider for future events.

Projects poised to deliver significant benefits to the wider community, with strong potential

to draw in new contributors, keep current ones engaged, and enhance GitLab's standing among competitors. For more information, please refer to the detailed descriptions in the background document or contact the DRI of this competition.

Pitch Helper sessions guide contributors in effectively showcasing their ideas and deliberating on the elements of a standout solution. These workshops are instrumental in enhancing the quality of contributions and highlighting compelling projects for the GitLab team. Internally referring to the competitions AMA session 4 as an example.

GitLab LLM proposes a solution to GitLab's extensive yet scattered information landscape, distributed across numerous channels in a fragmented and siloed manner, making it challenging to navigate. The recommendation is to create an AI capable of sifting through these disparate silos to compile the most accurate and relevant responses to specific inquiries, including sources.

The Community Pairing App aims to connect contributors seeking teammates, spotlight intriguing projects for interested contributors, and assist in promoting visibility for their initiatives. Also in this situation the recommendation is to create an AI that surfaces relevant contact information.

GitLab News TV offers a regular dose of GitLab updates through engaging, bite-sized YouTube bulletins, designed for both the GitLab team and the broader community. Covering a range of topics from new releases and MVP highlights to innovative solutions, unique initiatives, and conference updates, each segment is delivered in concise, easily digestible clips. With a focus on fast-paced, entertaining content, GitLab TV ensures viewers stay informed and connected. Timestamps for effortless navigation and detailed show notes guide viewers to further information effortlessly.

Social Impact Specials spotlight areas of societal importance that GitLab aims to enhance through focused development efforts. By concentrating on social themes, GitLab not only reinforces its dedication to Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) but also distinguishes itself in the competitive landscape. These initiatives could also serve as additional channels for attracting new contributors. It's recommended to explore targeted industries or development areas further. Example themes include:

- Improving mobility for people with disabilities to foster better inclusion, possibly through enhancing or developing security software for autonomous vehicles.

- Enhancing access to health data by focusing on its security, user authentication, authorization, traceability, and overall trust.

- Advancing company documentation by creating tools (guardrails) that detect bias or employ AI to refine search capabilities.

- Leverage the power of AI to reduce carbon footprint or to improve the yield of alternative energy sources.

- Create components aimed at achieving a more equitable distribution of intellectual property rights or providing assistance to the unbanked and uninsured.

Beyond the Platform initiatives that transcend the traditional boundaries of a coding community. For example advice on healthier living, tips to manage mental stress, and guidance for career growth. GitLab is not just about code and contributions; it's about caring for you as a human being (see also: 'Social Impact Specials' above). This approach aligns perfectly with the GitLab ethos and is not a radical shift but a natural progression.

Closing

Key points

The primary objective of the inaugural edition was to enhance contributor engagement on the platform, with a specific emphasis on the CI/CD component store, artificial intelligence, and social impact.

The competition achieved success in terms of both submission quality and quantity, establishing robust groundwork for subsequent editions and positioning GitLab favorably within the competitive landscape.

Special thank you

To our esteemed Judges: Your dedication and thorough evaluation of submissions, amidst demanding schedules and amidst ambiguous guidelines, were remarkable. Your insightful feedback is invaluable for enhancing future editions. We extend our deepest gratitude for your exceptional contribution.

To the Legal Department: We acknowledge the extraordinary demands placed upon your team, navigating an influx of inquiries and complex issues. Your timely, insightful responses and proactive engagement have been pivotal. Thank you for your unwavering commitment and excellence.

To the Contributor Success & Developer Relations team: We deeply appreciate your invaluable support, candid insights, and the positive impact you've made. A special acknowledgment to Abubakar for turning challenges into achievements, and to Fatima for her outstanding dedication and enthusiasm.

To Nick Veenhof: His resilience and patience in addressing unexpected challenges, and your comprehensive, round-the-clock guidance, have been fundamental to the success of this initiative. His dedication to maintaining and advocating for our vision has truly set a standard. Thanks for his extraordinary efforts.

To Bart Collet: His perseverance knows no limit. He goes for results and nothing less. An exceptional and natural born leader striving for more innovation in the world.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/merge-request-coach-lifecycle.md

Applying to become a Merge Request Coach

- Create a new issue using the mrcoachonboarding template (see screenshot below).
- Fill in the placeholders in the issue template with your information.
- Assign the issue to yourself.
- Work through the steps in that new issue.

Stepping down gracefully

If you are no longer able to serve as a Merge Request Coach, you should identify another GitLab team member to take your place so that the capacity of the remaining coaches remains the same. When you are ready to step down, you need to:

1. Make an announcement on the mr-coaching Slack channel.
1. Update the team.yml file to remove "Merge Request Coach".
1. Remove yourself from the @gitlab-org/coaches group.

References/resources

1. Merge Request Coach responsibilities
1. Merge Request Coach collaboration guidelines
1. Community Discord channel: please join if you haven't already!

Current Merge Request Coaches

GitLab currently has {{< department-member-count "Merge Request Coach" >}} merge request coaches:

{{< department-members "Merge Request Coach" >}}

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/metrics.md

Dashboards we use

To view the dashboard your browser must allow third-party cookies.

- Wider Community PIs
 - Unique Wider Community Contributors per Month
 - Amount of MRs created, merged & closed
 - Time between MR created and merged (OCMA)
 - Time between MR ready for review & reviewed
- Leading Organizations PIs
 - Time to review SLO
 - Open MRs from Leading Organizations & their age
- MRARR Dashboard
 - Customers ARR Number of MRs
 - Shows how we are doing towards the target
- MRARR Diagnostics
 - Identifies MRs from customers that are not being tracked yet
 - Identifies projects with contributions that are not being tracked yet
 - See Contributing Orgs tracker for details

Tableau dashboard

productcommunitycontributionmrs

Merge requests with ~"Community contribution" label, opened in projects that are part of the product.

The results include MR type, MR age, MR labels, MR stage, MR group, MR section.

Finding the absolute Merge Request URL

It includes 4 joins of the gitlabdotcomgroupsxsf table. This is because it is hard to understand the entire hierarchy from the namespace itself. A namespace can be nested within a group of a

group of a group, or deeper. So it's important to find the entire hierarchy so we can re-assemble the full URL path of this particular Merge Request.

The end result could be, in the maximum form:

<https://gitlab.com/group4/group3/group2/group1/projectpath/mergerequests/mergerequestid>

Categorization of MRs

Given that not all MRs have type labels yet, we try to guess the type based on existing labels. In the snippet you can clearly see the 3 types being represented (feature, maintenance, bug).

Last Active Date

The snippet also goes to great lengths to find out when a merge request was last active. Given that the state could either be open, merged or closed, it has a different logic for each state to understand what the last active date was. Using this date, it can then be used to understand the amount of days the merge request was or is open for, also known as Merge Request Age.

Excluding users from the report

There are certain authors or MRs that are excluded from the reports as they belong to the GitLab organization and should not be accounted for when looking at our Community MR metrics. If you do see authors that should be excluded, they should be added to this snippet so they can be excluded from the metrics in the future. Example users are the GitLab Bot, Release Bot, Reviewer/Recommender Bot, etc...

communitycontributionsbase

Similar to productcommunitycontributionmrs, but the results include MR lifecycle data (time to triage, time to first review, projected days to merge etc).

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/notable-contributor-process.md

GitLab Notable Contributor

Each month GitLab recognizes one or more community contributors as the GitLab Notable Contributor to be featured in the GitLab release post.

This was formerly known as GitLab MVP ("Most Valuable Person").

Nominations are a rolling process so that contributors can be nominated and supported at anytime.

The GitLab Notable Contributors are recognized within the GitLab release post and across Slack and Discord.

Notable Contributors also receive an achievement badge for their profile and GitLab swag credits in celebration of their contribution.

- Hall of fame list of GitLab Notable Contributors
- Release posts on GitLab blog

Workflow for selecting GitLab Notable Contributor

1. A rolling GitLab Notable Contributor nominations issue is used for the entire major release cycle (for example 18.0 through 18.11). Community contributors can be added to this issue at anytime.
 1. Use the notablecontributorworkflowtracker.md issue template to create an issue with a checklist of steps to follow during the selection process.
 1. Select one or more eligible Notable Contributors from the nomination issue.
 - Selections should be chosen based on contribution and community impact, nomination comments and emoji votes.
 - Selections should be completed at least 10 calendar days before the release date.
 1. If this is a minor release version, use the existing thread in the nominations issue announcing the Notable Contributor winner.
 - Be sure to ping and thank the nominators and anyone who added supportive comments for the nominees.
 - Add the Notable Contributor to the table in the top level description of the issue.

text

:tada: Congratulations to our X.Y Notable Contributor award winner X <https://gitlab.com/x>
Note about X's contributions.

A huge thank you to A B and C for nominating Notable Contributors and X Y and Z for adding support.

1. From the current release branch, draft a merge request for adding the new Notable Contributor
 - The first step is switching to the current release branch release-x-y in the www-gitlab-org project. Using the 15.8 release as an example, navigate to the current release branch directly on GitLab by selecting the release-15-8 branch from the dropdown menu. If working locally, checkout the release-15-8 branch.
 - Navigate to the mvp.yml file inside the current release folder under data/releaseposts/xy. In this example it would be the 158 folder which has a placeholder mvp.yml file inside.
 - NOTE: When there are multiple Notable Contributors, please use array syntax in the yaml files, when singular please avoid array syntax. Examples:

yaml

```
fullname: Single Recipient
gitlab: singleusername
```

yaml

```
fullname: ['First Recipient', 'Second Recipient']
gitlab: ['firstusername', 'secondusername']
```

- Begin drafting the merge request by updating the new Notable Contributor name and user handle. Remove the placeholder text for the write-up blurb. Commit the changes on a new branch. When creating the merge request on GitLab make sure your branch is targeting the current release branch release-x-y and not targeting master.

- Follow the steps to collaborate the Notable Contributor write-up blurb.
 - Add release version, Notable Contributor name, user handle, release post date and release post URL.
 - Assign another Contributor Success team member to review/merge and double check the merge request is targeting the correct release branch.
 - Ping the release post manager into the MR for awareness.
 - Merge by the Tuesday of release week.
1. Add the Notable Contributor to the Recipients section of the Notable Contributors platform page
 - Update notable-contributors.md in the contributors-gitlab-com project
 - Follow the existing version and date format to link to the notable-contributor header of the upcoming release post page
 - Follow the existing format to link to the winner's GitLab profile
 - If more than one winner, use an inline line break
 to separate contributor names
 - Use the feature changelog trailer in the commit message to generate release notes
 - Merge and deploy prior to the live release post date
 1. Award the Notable Contributor winner with the Notable Contributor achievement by running the following query in GraphQL. (You will need to be a Maintainer of the Achievements Group. By default Contributor Success team members should have rights.) If there are no errors, you have succeeded! You can also verify the achievement by visiting the MVP's GitLab profile.

```

graphql
mutation {
  achievementsAward(
    input: {achievementId: "gid://gitlab/Achievements::Achievement/53", userId:
"gid://gitlab/User/<user id>"}
  ) {
    userAchievement {
      id
      achievement {
        id
        name
      }
      user {
        id
        username
      }
    }
    errors
  }
}

```

NOTE: To find a userId from a username, visit the GitLab profile page for the user and click the dropdown ellipsis (kebab menu) in the upper right corner.

1. Follow the steps for Sending Notable Contributor Rewards.
1. After release post goes live, link the Notable Contributor section of the release post in Slack whats-happening-at-gitlab channel along with a reminder to add new nominations.

md

:mega: Check out our latest GitLab Notable Contributors X & Y in the X.Y release post!

You can nominate community contributors in the rolling nominations issue here:

<https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success/team-task/-/issues/?labelname%5B%5D=Notable%20contributor%20nominations>

Please add any community contributors throughout the year whenever you see a helpful contribution. Your support now will help them when they make future contributions to GitLab too!

1. Forward the message to developer-relations, mr-coaching, and core
1. Share the message in the Discord announcements channel and thank any wider community members who added nominations or support.
1. Update the nomination issue and the nominated thread to document the winner.

Notable Contributor Eligibility

- The Contributor Success team will make the final choice on the GitLab Notable Contributor award selection.
- The Contributor Success team will consider one or more Notable Contributors as appropriate.
- A contributor is eligible to be Notable Contributor once per major release cycle. For example, if they are Notable Contributor during any 17. milestone, they cannot be a Notable Contributor again until the 18.0 milestone.
- View past Notable Contributors on the contributor platform.
- Contributors may be nominated whether they have contributed to the current release cycle or not. Contributors are recognized for previous and ongoing contributions to GitLab.
 - E.g. See the 15.8 Notable Contributor selected for prior release work and the 15.7 Notable Contributor selected for steady contributions.

Notable Contributor Write-Up Blurb

Use the data/releaseposts/xy/mvp.yml merge request to collaborate on the Notable Contributor write-up with the Notable Contributor winner, nominator and other team members.

The Notable Contributor write-up section should:

- Contain a brief description of the Notable Contributor's contributions to GitLab.
- Links to relevant issues, MRs, issue boards or epics the Notable Contributor contributed to.
- Links for the nominator and/or supporters with quotes about the Notable Contributor.
- A quote or any details from the Notable Contributor if provided.
- The role or organization of the Notable Contributor if provided.
- Contributor Success is responsible for reviewing the entry for:
 - Consistency and accuracy
 - Correct and working links for user information, issues, MRs, etc.
 - Correct spelling of names, organizations, product features, etc.
 - Correct pronoun usage
- The write-up should be merged by the Tuesday of release week to the data/releaseposts/xy/mvp.yml file targeting the specific release branch

You can use the sample message below when pinging the Notable Contributor winner and team

members into the merge request:

text

Hi {WINNER} :wave:

Congrats on being selected as GitLab's {X.Y} Notable Contributor!

We are working on a write-up for you that will be included in the {X.Y} release post. For reference you can check out our past Notable Contributor list and here are a few notable examples:

- <https://about.gitlab.com/releases/2025/04/17/gitlab-17-11-released/notable-contributor>
- <https://about.gitlab.com/releases/2024/04/18/gitlab-16-11-released/notable-contributor>
- <https://about.gitlab.com/releases/2024/03/21/gitlab-16-10-released/notable-contributor>
- <https://about.gitlab.com/releases/2024/02/15/gitlab-16-9-released/notable-contributor>
- <https://about.gitlab.com/releases/2023/07/22/gitlab-16-2-released/notable-contributor>
- <https://about.gitlab.com/releases/2023/02/22/gitlab-15-9-released/notable-contributor>

Please let us know if there are any details you would like us to highlight about yourself, your work or your contributions to the GitLab community.

I'm also pinging {NOMINATOR} {COMMENTER} who either nominated or commented on your contributions in the {NOMINATIONISSUE}. They can also chime in with anything worth noting for the release post write-up or a quote about your contributions.

We only have a few days to put this together. If we don't hear back or you don't have the time we will do our best to put something together! The {X.Y} release post will go live on the release date.

Finally we will work to get your GitLab swag sent over soon!

Sending Notable Contributor Rewards

After selecting the Notable Contributor and working through the the workflow for selecting Notable Contributors:

1. Visit contributors.gitlab.com/rewards
1. Issue 150 contributor store credits to their username (if multiple winners, each winner gets 150 credits)
1. Select the "Notable contributor (MVP)" option from the Reason dropdown
1. Include an optional thank you note or link to the release post

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/user-journey.md

Journey Map

<div style="overflow-x: scroll;">

```

mermaid
%%{init: {"flowchart": { "useMaxWidth": false } }}%%
flowchart TB
    start("New Contributor")

    subgraph id4["Contribute"]
        id4heading("Ways to contribute")
        id4box1("Contribute to Code")
        id4box2("Non Code contribution")
        id4heading --> id4box1
        id4heading --> id4box2

        click id4box1 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/contributing/"
    end

    end

    subgraph id5["Contribution Process"]

        subgraph id5box1["Tutorial: Make a GitLab contribution"]
            end
            subgraph id5sg0["Join Community Forks (optional/advised)"]
                end
                subgraph id5sg1["Developer Environment"]
                    end
                    subgraph id5sg2["Issue workflow"]
                        end
                        subgraph id5sg3["MR workflow"]
                            end

            direction TB
            id5box1 --> id5sg0
            id5sg0 --> id5sg1
            id5sg1 --> id5sg2
            id5sg2 --> id5sg3
            %% id5sg3 --> id5sg4
            %% id5sg4 --> id5sg5
            %% id5sg5 --> id5sg6
            %% id5sg6 --> id5sg7
            %% id5sg7 --> id5sg8

            click id5box1
            "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/contributing/firstcontribution.html"
            click id5sg1 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/contributing/set-up-the-gitlab-development-kit"
            click id5sg2 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/contributing/issueworkflow.html"
            click id5sg3
            "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/contributing/mergerequestworkflow.html"
            click id5sg0 "https://gitlab.com/gitlab-community/community-members"
        end
    end

```

```

subgraph id7["."]
  direction RL
    id7box0["Developer Env"]
    id7sg1["Local dev"]
    id7sg2["Remote Dev"]
    id7box1["Gitpod"]
    id7box2["Web IDE"]
    id7box3["GDK"]

    id7box0 --> id7sg1
    id7box0 --> id7sg2
    id7sg2 --> id7box1
    id7sg2 --> id7box2
    id7sg1 --> id7box3

    click id7box1 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/integration/gitpod.html"
    click id7box2 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/user/project/webide/"
    click id7box3 "https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab-development-kit/-/blob/main/README.md"
  end

subgraph id8["Issue workflow"]
  direction RL
    subgraph id8sg1["Finding an Issue"]
    end
    subgraph id8sg2["Claiming the Issue"]
    end
    subgraph id8sg3["Opening a Merge Request"]
    end
    subgraph id8sg4["Working on an Issue"]
    end
    subgraph id8sg5["Completing the implementation Plan"]
    end

    click id8sg4
    "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/contributing/issueworkflow.html#working-on-the-issue"
  end

end

subgraph id9["MR Workflow"]
  direction TB
    subgraph id9sg1["Follow MR Guidelines"]
    end
    subgraph id9sg2["Changelog Entries/Conventional Commits"]
    end
  end

```

```

subgraph id9sg3["Create draft MR"]
end
subgraph id9sg4["Pipeline Runs"]
end
subgraph id9sg5["Triage Process"]
end
subgraph id9sg6["@gitlab-bot ready"]
end
subgraph id9sg7["Code Review Process"]
end
subgraph id9sg8["Make changes"]
end
subgraph id9sg9["Finally getting it merged"]
end

```

```

click id9sg2 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/changelog.html"

```

```

id9sg1 --> id9sg2
id9sg2 --> id9sg3
id9sg3 --> id9sg4
id9sg4 --> id9sg5
id9sg5 --> id9sg6
id9sg6 --> id9sg7
id9sg7 --> id9sg8
id9sg8 --> id9sg7
id9sg8 --> id9sg9

```

```

end

```

```

subgraph id1["Ask Questions"]
  id1box1("Discord")
  %% id1box2("FAQs")
  id1box3("GitLab Forum")

```

```

click id1box1 "https://discord.gg/rxWqW5e8"
%% click id1box2 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/feguide/frontendfaq.html"
click id1box3 "https://forum.gitlab.com/"

```

```

end

```

```

subgraph id2["Engagements"]
  id2box1("Co-working Days")
  id2box2("Office hours")
  id2box3("Community Pairing")
  id2box4("Hackathons")

```

```

click id2box2 "https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/marketing/developer-
relations/contributor-success/community-office-hours"
click id2box3 "https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/marketing/developer-
relations/contributor-success/community-pairing-sessions.html"
click id2box4 "https://handbook.gitlab

```